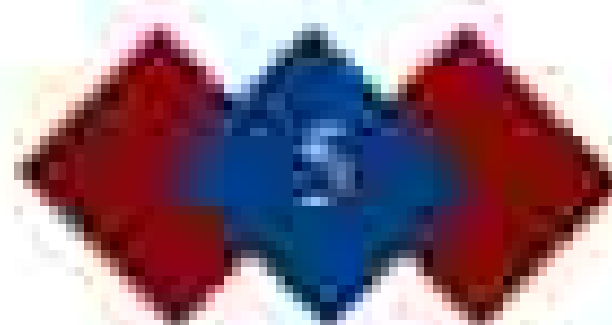


Art & Literature Revolutions



The Renaissance as an Artistic Revolution

Luna Sawina and Sara Al medraji

Abstract

This scholarly article covers the Renaissance as a transformative period with a dual aim of reviving interest

classical style and creating new ways of representing art. The article investigates how developments in perspective, anatomy, and conceptual accuracy would continue and fuel artistic realism and individuality in art. The study argues that artists, in particular, the Medici family, were vital in paving the way for artistic innovation and the diffusion of Renaissance ideas across Europe. Thus, instead of focusing strictly on the religious aspect, Renaissance art shifted to showcasing the secular and humanist values under the influence of individualism and intellectual movement. The findings of the article indicate that by revolutionizing the complexity of art, the Renaissance also laid the early foundations for modern Western institutions and paradigms of artistic expression that would govern for several centuries.

Keywords: Renaissance, Classical style, Perspective, Patron, Individuality

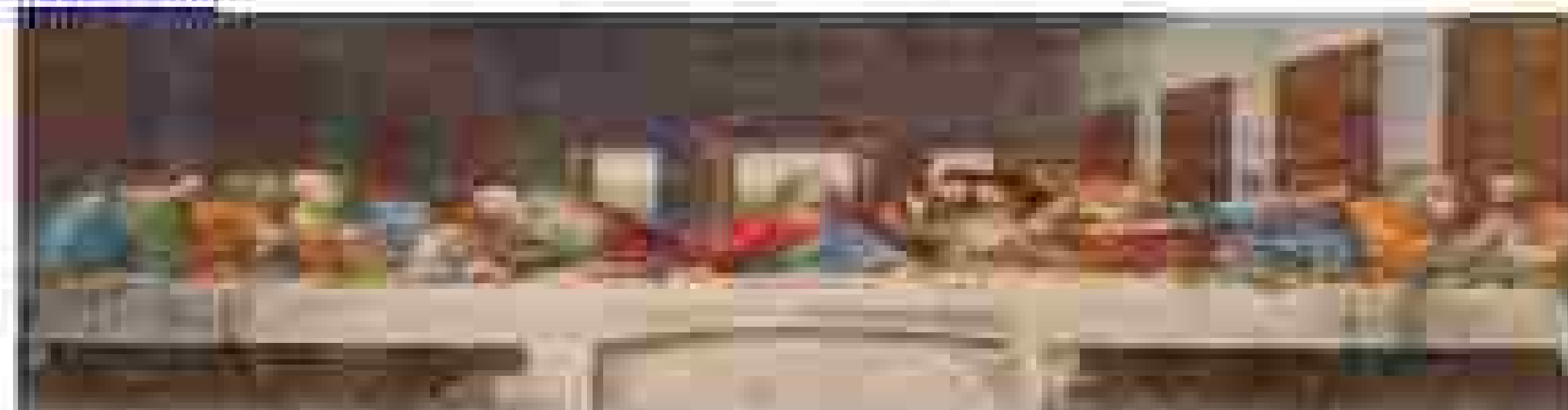
Introduction

The Renaissance, which translates to "rebirth" in French, was not just a period for art, science, intellectual, and cultural awakening (Hirshman, 2012). It was a period of cultural rejuvenation in Europe between the 14th and 16th centuries when there was renewed interest in the writings of ancient Greek and Roman that revolutionized European society in all aspects of culture, science, and philosophy (Farr, 2012). The term "The Renaissance" though not consistently used until the 19th century, Swiss historian Jacob Burckhardt revolutionized it in *The Renaissance of the Italian City-States* (Burckhardt, 1916). And as a subject, Renaissance art started a transition from the perspective of a human or humanistic perspective and experience. During this period, a transformation took place known as the Renaissance movement. Artistic during this time were represented by artists (Carr-Saunders, 2017). Therefore, they desired for authentic method proposed for using their paintings and sculptures as life as a more authentic image than what was before. Rhetorical figures, the *Liber Verborum* de Verborum and *Metaphors*, emerged during this period as symbols of excellence pushing the limits of creativity while utilizing new human surrounding human experience nature and spirituality (Carr-Saunders, 2017). During the art of the Renaissance, history was dominated by the location of the growing power which made it possible to share information and ideas with a wider population during the age of world exploration, and new cultural concepts were produced in Europe (Carr-Saunders, 2017). Therefore, this time was considered to be replaced by whether during the Renaissance era, and this led to breakthrough in literature, science, such as literature, science, and philosophy. The focus of art expression and reflected experiences changed notably significantly, creating a lasting impact by connecting the art with individual (Carr-Saunders, 2017). This cultural movement was a departure from traditional religious structure to a celebration of individual expression and human experience, captured through art and intellectual pursuit. Techniques such as anatomy, which incorporated light and shadow, and linear perspective transformed paintings into realistic, three-dimensional representations (Carr-Saunders, 2017). The Renaissance was also breaking old ideas and creating a new world of ideas, ideas that led to humanism and laid the seeds for knowledge that helped create modern world with discovery (Carr-Saunders, 2017). Additionally, the era's artists have remained at the forefront of history, whose contributions, technical skills and creativity, as well as their, often pioneering and often influential generation of ideas is alive (World History Encyclopedia, 2019). This article, therefore, was complemented by scientific research supported by Leonardo da Vinci, who established the fields of art and science with anatomical studies that influenced the understanding of the human body (Hirshman, 2012). Together, these advancements in technique and ideology laid the foundation for the modern Western world, contributing cultural wealth with a refined approach in artistic expression.

Subtopic 1: What Sparked the Renaissance Artistic Revolution?

There was a strong regular of social, cultural, and economic conditions in Europe between the 14th and the 17th centuries that gave rise to the emergence of Renaissance (Hillery, 2021). It was essentially a revival of classical antiquity, with scholarly and literary works drawing inspiration from the art of ancient Greece and Rome. Renaissance artists were influenced by Greek and Roman art because of their desire to restore some of the lost art and properties, which were considered to have been obliterated and the study of ancient history (Hillery, 2021). This was further helped by the fall of Constantinople in 1453, where Byzantine scholars fled to Italy, bringing with them classical manuscripts of civil service with (Hillery, 2021). The arrival of human in literature, with its focus on humanistic and personal, historical, intellectual, expression, and freedom in the arts (Hillery, 2021). Another significant driver was the increasing prosperity of the nation like

[Hillery, 2021](#) ::
[Hillery, 2021](#) ::



France and Spain became cultural hubs during this time. The freedom to create new art and building came from rich patrons, such as the Medici family, who are widely recognized as patrons of Renaissance (Hillery, 2021). With the return to power of Cosimo de Medici (also known as Cosimo the Elder) in 1464, Florence became the birthplace of the Renaissance, Europe's scientific, artistic, and cultural movement, thanks to the family's support of the arts and literature (Hillery, 2021). This was the only way Leonardo da Vinci and Michelangelo could have created their new ideas and techniques (Hillery, 2021). Renaissance became significantly more accessible and inclusive

thanks to the printing machine around 1440. This made it possible for the general public to access historical writings, artistic theories, and scientific discoveries at a time when some were being greatly disseminating literacy and education (Hillery, 2021). The era was also largely influenced by the dominant Christian religious and moral perspectives. The decline of the feudal system and the rising authority of the Church gave way to humanism. Humanism is a philosophy that focuses on the individual and the potential of the human mind. Additionally, humanism rejected the rigid system that was followed in the use of the most important and simple systems of the early civilization (Hillery, 2021). Renaissance art transformed the change in the way it portrayed its subjects with humanism, dynamic poses, and realistic settings that broke away from the flat and symbolic styles of the medieval period (Hillery, 2021). Combined, these factors provided just the right environment for artists to express their ideas and to create a new world where the cultural and intellectual life of Europe

Subtopic 2: Intellectual, Cultural, and Artistic Breakthroughs

The Renaissance was a time of intellectual, cultural, and artistic "awakening" that followed the Middle Ages (Hillery, 2021). Standing as a historical period in history, artists, scientists, the Renaissance marked the awakening of new traditions that had remained a suppressed for centuries. Under the strict, basic, and ordered traditions of the previous medieval and Byzantine periods, artists aimed to establish a new sense of identity and

was often its own media. Artists also played major roles as active patrons as seen in the paintings on the subject of Leonardo da Vinci's "Mona Lisa" as the decorated phase in Botticelli's "Primavera" (Caryon 2013). In following, the invention of oil paint helped achieve completely flat Renaissance wall-paints, which is one of the features of new painting methods. Italian artists use perspective, foreshortening, and proportion as the most important methods developed throughout the Renaissance (Mazzoni & Tschopp 2019 Renaissance Art). In turn, the invention of foreshortening changed with the introduction of these methods. Leonardo da Vinci, an Italian polymath of the High Renaissance, was responsible for the creation of the "Vitruvian" Man, which focuses on soft, organic, or blurred, describing the delicate blending of colors and the softening of distinct lines (Caryon 2013). Strong contrasts between light and dark are used in a Renaissance to add depth. The gradual tone transition provides the appearance of depth, constructed through its use applied in perspective, foreshortening, and proportion. The capacity to construct three-dimensional figures on a two-dimensional plane was substantially advanced by the construction of linear perspective (Tschopp, 2019). In addition, to the use of the chain approach in the formation of an entire line found from the figure on canvas. Foreshortening greatly in the Renaissance, being an entire canvas being constructed. Perspective painter like Michelangelo required a more precise system. The body's extension extended as they moved toward two million, dynamics of the human body. The body extended beyond the body's surface, the torso and limbs as they pass easily through for this were also of course (Caryon 2013).

Subtopic 3: Early Renaissance (14th – Early 16th Century)

The artistic approach of the era was greatly influenced by Leonardo's utilization of the human experiment and foreshortening in the pursuit of the individual at work, 2013. Giotto di Bondone was a significant figure and is considered to



be one of the first Renaissance painters. The use of depth and emotion in the figures in his paintings in Padua's Scrovegni Chapel was a dramatic departure from the flat, symbolic images typical of earlier art (Caryon 2013). One of the major ways Giotto inspired Renaissance painting was through his depth and perspective, giving his figures a feeling of three-dimensionality, rather than being flat and two-dimensional (Caryon 2013).

Leonardo (2013). This was a significant concept that would eventually come to define the Renaissance art. It was one of the most important developments during the early Renaissance (Caryon 2013). Linear perspective was introduced by Filippo Brunelleschi, an Italian architect who lived between 1377 and 1446 (Henderson, 2014).

By creating the flat, two-dimensional perspective of previous centuries, his system allowed painters to depict situations that were more realistic and spatially precise (The Art News, 2013). Giotto's paintings in Padua's Scrovegni Chapel demonstrated the use of linear perspective. The artist employed perspective to give figures and structures a sense of depth and volume. Brunelleschi, another important early Renaissance figure, demonstrated a similar idea in his study of human body representations. Brunelleschi produced the first perspective cube designs from analogy with the human figure of David (Caryon 2013). In addition to creating the individual sense of space, the sculpture gave sculpture a feeling of three-dimensionality and emotional expression. A new technique for Renaissance artists was the ability of Brunelleschi to depict the human body classically and realistically (Mazzoni & Tschopp 2019 Renaissance Art). This concept is important because the art revolution that would take place in the following hundred years was largely enabled by the creation of perspective, foreshortening, and proportion (Henderson, 2014). It changed the world as we know it today.

Subtopic 4: The High Renaissance (Late 15th – Early 16th Century)

The High Renaissance (Late 15th – Early 16th Century) The High Renaissance, which was in its 30 years, was defined as the golden age of the Italian Renaissance (Adams, 2002). It was described as a short period when the most remarkable master artworks were created. The main factors that were essential in contributing to the development of paintings during the High Renaissance were technical, literary, spiritual and humanistic (Adams, 2002).

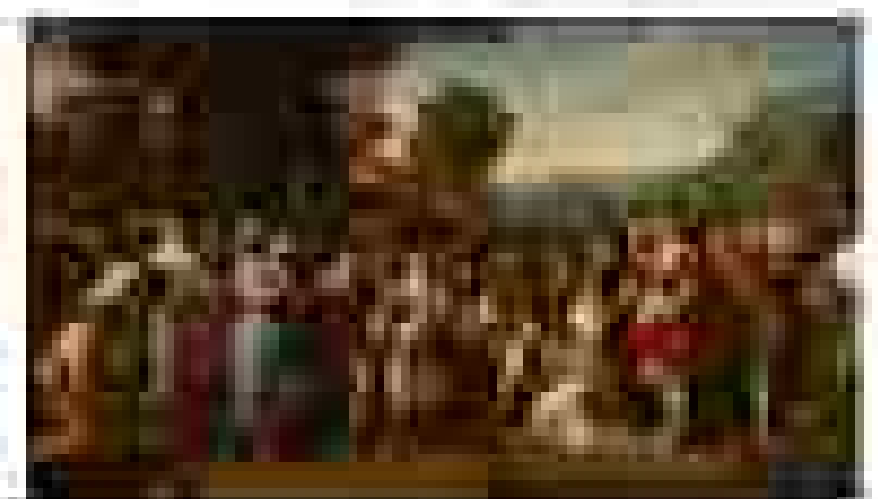


However, by the time of painting techniques had found their way into the hands of standing oil painter who could now work more imaginatively around other Italian ideas, the principal ideas of humanism put out of literary, medieval art tradition on the basis of empirical theory. They were some that was dominated by three masters: **Leonardo da Vinci (1452–1519)**, **Michelangelo (1475–1564)**, and **Raphael (1483–1520)** (Harrison, 2002). All of them had created their artworks as part of the art of the moment. Leonardo was the prototype Renaissance man, being skilled in art as well as science. Michelangelo focused on human form as the ultimate source of personal expression. Raphael created art that embodied the Classical spirit – beautiful, harmonious, and serene (Harrison, 2002). The period also saw enormous patronage by powerful families

like the Medici and the Vatican, which sustained the creation of gigantic works of art. Oil painting was employed more skillfully in more depth and realism in such works as Raphael's *School of Athens*. Artists also increasingly focused on the observation of human anatomy and nature, reflecting theories being developed by humanists and as such, works have immensely increased. Leonardo's sfumato technique, for example, allowed him to create smooth gradations of light and shadow, as seen in the *Mona Lisa* (Harrison, 2002). All such artistic innovations, leading to the traditional period of humanism, led Renaissance art to unprecedented levels of artistic and technical depth (Harrison, 2002).

Subtopic 5: The Rise of Humanism and Its Influence

This very same time was dominated by three master giants: **Leonardo da Vinci (1452–1519)**, **Michelangelo (1475–1564)**, and **Raphael (1483–1520)** (Harrison, 2002). All of them had created their artworks as part of the art of the moment. Leonardo was the prototype Renaissance man, being skilled in art as well as science. Michelangelo focused on human form as the ultimate source of personal expression. Raphael created art that embodied the Classical spirit – beautiful, harmonious, and serene (Harrison, 2002). The period also saw enormous patronage by powerful families like the Medici and the Vatican, which sustained the creation of gigantic works of art. Oil painting was employed more skillfully in more depth and realism



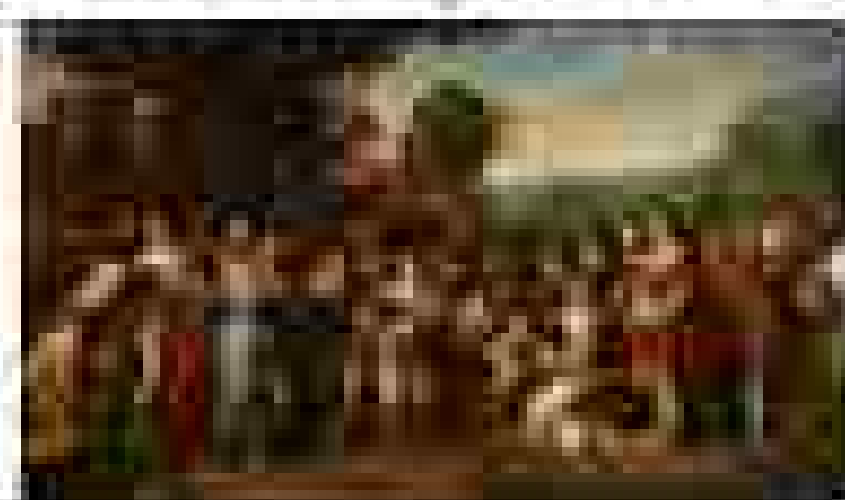
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critical thought, humanism moved people to seek intellectual autonomy and personal-enrichment standards. The focus on knowledge influenced not just literary literature but also established the groundwork for scientific breakthroughs and exploration throughout the Renaissance (Meyer, 2019). As humanism expanded, it changed the cultural makeup of Europe, allowing better governance and creating a lasting legacy of creativity and ingenuity.

Subtopic 5: The Rise of Humanism and Its Influence

This very era has been dominated by three major giants: Leonardo da Vinci (1452–1519), Michelangelo (1475–1564), and Raphael (1483–1520) (Harrison, 2018). All of them had shared their genius as yet they lived at the same time. Leonardo was the undisputed Renaissance man, doing efforts in various domains. Michelangelo's education

Raphael (1483) as the efficient master of classical expression. Raphael's impact on the time reflected the classical gods – beautiful, harmonious, and serene (Harrison, 2018). The period also saw extensive patronage for powerful families like the Medici and the Vatican, which cemented the creation of public works of art. History's latter perspective was employed from 1800s to create multi-dimensional works of art. Raphael's



School of Athens (The Art History). Art is also increasingly focused on the distribution of human resources and nature, studying their impact on the human form and to create works from previously uncharted Leonardo's classical techniques, for example, offered him to study natural positions of light and shadow, as seen in his Mona Lisa (Museum of Modern Art). All such artistic innovations started as the hallmark period of Renaissance, led by humanism as a conceptual break of history and universal depth (Schwartz, 2019). This philosophical transformation also played a vital role in highlighting the worth of humanity and the value of critical thought, humanism moved people to seek intellectual autonomy and personal-enrichment standards. The focus on knowledge influenced not just literary literature but also established the groundwork for scientific breakthroughs and exploration throughout the Renaissance (Meyer, 2019). As humanism expanded, it changed the cultural makeup of Europe, allowing better governance and creating a lasting legacy of creativity and ingenuity.

Subtopic 7: Technological Innovations and Their Impact on Renaissance Art

While focusing a lot of artistic achievement, the Renaissance was also a time of significant technological progress that revolutionized how art was created and spread. One of the most significant of these innovations was the invention of oil paint as a replacement for traditional tempera paint. Figures using oil-painted colors to produce



rather than, be able to create more detail, and a wider range of colors compared with the help of tempera (the glowing and shining) (Meyer, 2019). With the new brush, the texture, the manipulation of oil paint is being done the master's hands and death is an artwork now required. One of the most revolutionary technological advances in this period came about through the work of Johannes Vermeer with

the invention of the painting glass technique around the middle of the 16th century (Harrison, 2018). This changed the world of art by allowing artists techniques, concepts, and aesthetics to be more accessible. The gradual change that came usually represented that trade and signifying allowed artists to learn and imitate classical styles, accelerating the dissemination of the Renaissance standards of architecture, science that had been

The access to published materials facilitated the dissemination and representation of art information and reported generation of artworks and artists. In addition, Renaissance is progressive and associated to more & less fully influenced representation in artwork (Hassmann, 2012). Leonardo da Vinci and Albrecht Dürer were the most successful influence of human learning to apply the degree of line as an artistic realistic appearance (Hassmann, 2012). Linear perspective, even though originally conceived by Filippo Brunelleschi, became a standard art technique that gave sense to ability to create an illusion of space and three-dimensionality in two-dimensional surface (Hassmann, 2012).

Schöpfung 3: The Influence of Architecture on Renaissance Art

The Influence of Architecture on Renaissance Art Classical architecture, beginning in Italy and spreading the artistic style between 1400 and 1600, was revived during the Renaissance period (Carterright, 2010). The revival of classical influenced the arts in terms of aesthetics. During the Renaissance period, architects drew from the ancient Greeks and Romans for proportions, symmetry, and balance and standardized the patterns and designs for future art (Carterright, 2012). Filippo Brunelleschi, a pioneer of Renaissance architecture, used linear perspective, a mathematical technique whereby the artist can create an illusion of a three-dimensional space on a two-dimensional plane (Carterright, 2012). It was a technique that revolutionized the nature of painting in the Renaissance, used by Masaccio in *The Holy Trinity* and Leonardo da Vinci in *The Last Supper*. Other architectural representations of the Renaissance era include, *Isidoro*, and *Diego*. Masaccio, like in the case of St. Peter's Basilica and the Florence Cathedral, Dürer was another of the powerful artists and great human influences, which were also represented in several paintings and artworks made during the Renaissance period (Oxford Art Online). It was essential for artists to incorporate architectural knowledge in their artwork. His very first detailed and powerful square perspective and depth. After the Michelangelo perfected matching knowledge of architecture and artwork to create pieces of harmony, and use this in the design for the museum of the Laurentian Library (Kerry, 2014). The use in impacts on composition and technique. Renaissance architecture required sophisticated. The classical interest in humanistic change which was psychological and historical means opened a background of carefully realized architectural settings. In Brunelleschi's *Study of Athens*, classical arches and domes trace a gathering of philosophers and scholars, the intellectual and cultural themes of the painting (Hassmann, 2014). The blending of architecture and visual arts by Renaissance artists led Renaissance up with a degree of technical gradual capability in the artistic legacy of the era.



Schöpfung 3: The Evolution of Portraiture During the Renaissance

The Evolution of Portraits During the Renaissance During the Renaissance, portraiture changed significantly due to the growth in individualism, science, and technological change at the time. Whereas medieval portraits were symbolic and religious, portraits of the Renaissance tried to capture the individual human at their relation with a more scientific and personal perspective.

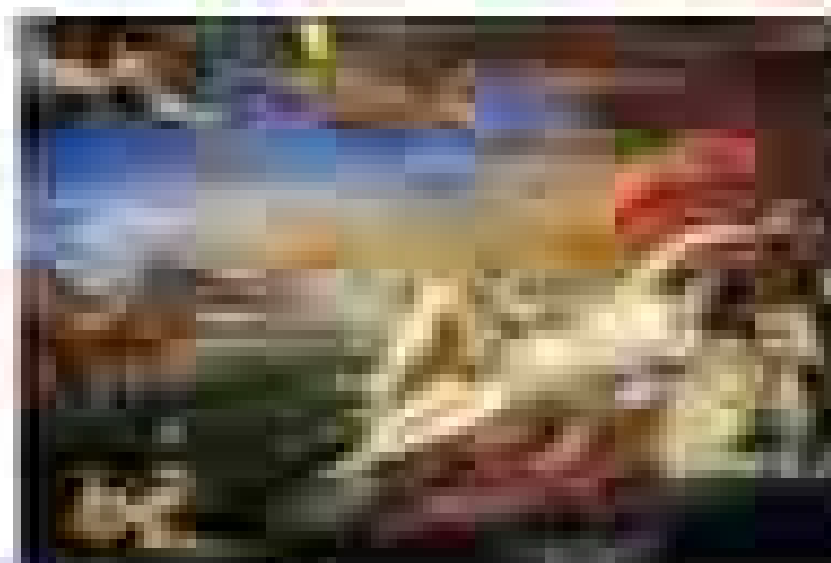
(Boschella, 2017). This shift was influenced by the rise of humanism, which placed greater value on personal identity and intellectual achievement (Fidel Gallery, 2022). Leonardo da Vinci and Hans Holbein the Younger were among those artists who developed such skills by studying anatomy, optics, and human expression, making their subjects appear natural and closer to life (Boschella, 2017). Another important characteristic of Renaissance portrait portraiture was that painting of gold, which would give more depth and richness to their colors, enabled the fine capturing of detailed emotions and added more beauty to flesh and clothes (Carrington, 2020). The technique allowed people across the sea, including several empires, to be given an image in which various natural changes between themselves and the greater collection.



With this, their work could be shown with clarity by a painter (Fidel Gallery, 2022). Moreover, artists began to experiment with different angles and camera angles. While medieval portraits were rigid and formal, Renaissance artists used Renaissance humanism and scientific ideas, believing that people had more like life, deep sense of humanity. In addition, people believed portraits as a sign of wealth and social status (Gallery of Art). It can be seen, for example, in the portraits by Titian and Hans Holbein, where the person in the portrait is elegantly garbed and seated and placed with large backgrounds that show (Gallerie, Arts & Culture). This is also substantiated by the fact that all portraits become more frequent, with artists portraying themselves as individuals and not just subjects, which reflected the Renaissance idea of an artist being a human person. These artists increasingly took part in the Renaissance itself more than the role of representation. It had knowledge, cultural, social, and intellectual revolution. The evolution of Renaissance portraiture is seen as a step, a sign of modernity, progress of culture and individual humanism that remained in the form of portraiture up to this day (Fidel Gallery, 2022).

Technique 10: The Impact of Classical Mythology on Renaissance Art

The impact of Classical Mythology on Renaissance Art From antiquity to antiquity, art, classical mythology and goddesses are subjects that have been inspired by ancient Greek and Roman figures, known along with the



world of science, especially after rediscovering old texts such as Plato's *Mythology*, which often provided beautiful stories about the gods (Gallerie, 2022). Renaissance artists such as Botticelli would connect with the subject of that passage, shown in *The Birth of Venus* and *Primavera* (Botticelli's work). These two classical mythologies would in some way change into the world of the World Library (Gallerie, 2022). The world's mythologies were and still are very complex

because mythology is full of characters from mythology art, which are mostly religious (e.g., gods, goddesses, and human figures) (Gallerie, 2022). In addition, portraits like

Romantic and Neoclassical artists focused on the mythological gods and heroes as Christian concepts of beauty, virtue, and heroism, while their successors looked to the Hellenism (Hellenistic Movement) of Art (1810). The subjects of classical mythology were also closely tied to the greater philosophical movement of the time, humanism, which emphasized the primacy of human nature and Greek antiquity (Hennrich, 2021). Consequently, mythological topics were withdrawn at the heart of Neoclassicism's art, becoming allusions to establishing a bridge between the distant past and modernity through a program that was more repulsive and aesthetically complex, transcending the classic tradition.

Schleier 11: Romanticism: Art and the Scientific Revolution

Romanticism, which reached its apex in the 19th century, was also the period when the Scientific Revolution was underway. This is an interesting relationship between scientific and artistic movements (Hennrich, 2021). Artists began looking outside the studio and during this period, including artists in Europe, America, and progressive Britain, (1817). Leonardo da Vinci, for example, was not only a great painter and architect but also a scientist. His anatomical studies of human anatomy had a direct influence on the representation of his portraits and sculptures, such as the famous work Vitruvian Man. They realized that in sharing the human body with scientific accuracy, something that was a source of inspiration for other scientists and artists was (Hennrich, 2021). Another fundamental relationship was between art and the invention of linear perspective, led by Filippo Brunelleschi. This technique, which created the illusion of depth on a flat surface, was based on geometric techniques and mathematical proportion, thus bridging artistic imagination and scientific rationality (Hennrich, 2021). The scientific process, led by the likes of Copernicus and Galileo, provided a more structured scientific framework, and this also helped to create a more scientific approach to the human form and world around them in the sense of observation and empirical investigation (Cambridge University Press, 2019). Therefore, Romanticism as a movement was closely related to intellectual currents of the Scientific Revolution, especially changing the two fields as they began looking more towards observation, experiment, and a more scientific understanding of nature (Michael Henry Bryan-Smith, 2020).



Figure 11

Schleier 12: The Decline of the Renaissance: Political and Religious Challenges

The decline of the Renaissance was influenced by many political and religious factors that shifted the focus away from the cultural optimism of the earlier period (The History of France: From the 16th century onwards). From foreign conquest and the presence of such powerful states as France and Spain, which weakened the independent movement, to internal political issues of the Renaissance. The sack of Rome in 1527 by Charles V, the Holy Roman Emperor's army, was a defining moment in Italy's cultural life, causing a direct loss of the thriving art and culture of Rome (Hennrich, 2024). The increasing power of the monarchy also saw a move away from the patronage system that had long supported artists and intellectuals. The decline in patronage had a telling effect on art production and the period of Renaissance art (Hennrich, 2024). The Protestant Reformation, especially Luther in 1517, questioned Catholic Church authority and altered the religious landscape of Europe. Thomas More's work as a result of the Reformation in the religious landscape was established and changed as the patronage of the arts by the Church. Artists who had received commissions from the Church found themselves working in a fragmented religious culture of uncertainty (2021). The Catholic Counter-Reformation also sought to reinforce

multitude of other values, which eventually found the expression of various Renaissance ideas, including the human (humanist and humanist) subjects (World History Encyclopedia, 2022). The changes in politics and religion contributed to the shaping of the Renaissance, which was a long period both chronologically and geographically in its end

Conclusion

The Renaissance was not just a reawakening to art and science but also the acceptance of people. It propelled society ahead by providing new ideas about the education, society, the old Greek and Roman beliefs. Beauty started to take on a different meaning. It transformed into a standard for expressing ideas, ideas, and feelings. Art came to life with the addition of new techniques and painting techniques. Humanism became more organized and defined, and perspective was introduced into painting. The Renaissance was not only characterized by art and architecture. With the progress of the printing press, knowledge started circulating in an unprecedented way. Humanism, philosophy, and science developed rapidly and inspired people to challenge the existing norms. The Vision was among the key points that shaped the world during the period. The Italian humanist Leonardo da Vinci painting, he studied the world around him. He used all his knowledge to understand nature, a masterpiece that was an anthropomorphic figure. Consequently, he painted with confidence. A combination of political, spiritual, religious, and scientific innovation gradually signaled the end of the Renaissance period and started the movement for new ideas. Nevertheless, the influence endured. As Michelangelo once said, "The greatest change has occurred in what that star will be in the light and in what it is, but that it is in the light, and in what it is" (Museum, 2018). The Renaissance is just the beginning of the story. It is time to be willing to move into a new era, a new era, a new era, and finally the renaissance. The future will come in, renaissance in the future, and the future will come in, renaissance in the future.